

## Poem: Cypress Street

### 3. Read these lines and answer the questions

*a. "According to my Great Aunt Gem  
There used to be a lot of them."*

i. What does the word '*them*' refer to?

**Answer: 'Them' refers to the cypress trees.**

ii. In these lines, find the antonym of '*not many*' or '*just a few*'.

**Answer: The antonym of 'not many' or 'just a few' is *a lot***

iii. What change has Great Aunt Gem noticed?

**Answer:** She has noticed that the cypress trees that once grew on the street have been cut down.

*b. "They cut them down. They took their wood  
A treeless street is plum no good!"*

i. The poet tells us that '*they*' cut down the trees. Who do you think cut down the trees?

**Answer: The workers or authorities who were developing the area such as builders or the city officials cut down the trees.**

ii. Why were the trees cut down?

**Answer: The trees were cut down to use their wood and to make space for development.**

iii. According to the poet, what else is no good without trees?

**Answer: According to the poet, a neighbourhood is no good without trees.**

4. Would it make the poet happy to have the name of the street changed to 'Lamppost Street'?

**Answer: No, it would not make the poet happy. He suggests it sarcastically to show his sadness and disappointment that the trees are gone.**

5. Why do you think the poet has written this poem?

**Answer: The poet has written this poem to make people aware of the importance of trees and to show how cutting them down harms the environment.**

6. What do you think the Mayor should discuss at the next meeting?

**Answer: The Mayor should discuss planting more trees and protecting nature while developing the city.**

7. Why is it important to have trees in a neighbourhood? Write your reasons.

**Answer: It is important to have trees in a neighbourhood because trees give us fresh air, provide shade and keep the area cool, make the neighbourhood beautiful, help birds and animals by giving them food and shelter.**

## MCQs

**1. What did the poet notice the most while walking on Cypress Street?**

- a) Lampposts instead of trees**
- b) Children playing
- c) Many shops
- d) Cars and buses

**2. Why is the street called Cypress Street?**

- a) It has many lampposts
- b) It is very long
- c) It is very hot
- d) It once had many cypress trees**

**3. Who tells the poet that there used to be many cypress trees?**

- a) The Mayor
- b) His friend
- c) His Great Aunt Gem**
- d) His neighbour

**4. What does the line “A treeless street is plum no good!” suggest?**

- a) Streets look better without trees
- b) Streets should have trees**
- c) Trees are unnecessary
- d) Trees are dangerous

**5. Why does the poet suggest changing the name to “Lamppost Street”?**

- a) He likes lampposts
- b) It is a joke to make people laugh
- c) To show his disappointment that trees are gone**
- d) The Mayor suggested it

## Chapter 12 The Girl Who Hated Books

### Map the Story

1. Is this story realistic or fantasy? Give a reason.

**This story is a fantasy because the characters and creatures like fairies, frogs, elephants, princes, and rabbits come out of books, which is not possible in real life.**

## 2. Imagery in the Story

a. List six descriptions of sound in the story

1. **“Meeeeeyooooow!”**
2. **Barking**
3. **Grunting**
4. **Thumping**
5. **Shouting**
6. **Cried**

b. list six action or movement words from the story

1. **Stamped**
2. **Ran**
3. **Slipped**
4. **Fell**
5. **Jumped**
6. **Dove**

3. What is the theme or the message of the Story “The Girl who Hated Books” that the writer wants to share with us?

**The message of the story is that books are full of adventure and imagination, and once we start reading, we can discover joy and excitement in them. Reading can change our attitude and open up new worlds.**

### **Deep Dive**

1. **“Worse still, her parents were always bringing home MORE books...”**

### **RECALL**

a. What were the different kinds of books Meena’s parents had bought for her?

**Ans) The different kinds of books Meena’s parents had bought for her were picture books, alphabet books, Nursery rhyme books, Fairy tales, adventure stories.**

### **INFER**

b. Which word in these sentences is an antonym for ‘better’?

**The antonym of ‘better’ in these lines is Worse**

c. In what way was Meena different from her parents?

**Meena hated reading books, while her parents loved reading and read all the time.**

### **ANALYSE**

d. Do you think Meena was bad-mannered? Give a reason.

**Yes, she was bad-mannered because she shouted at her parents and stamped her foot instead of politely expressing her feelings.**

**2. “When her parents came in that afternoon, they couldn’t believe their eyes.”**

### **RECALL**

a. What did Meena’s parents see when they came home?

**When Meena’s parents came home they saw Meena sitting in the middle of the room reading a book.**

### **INFER**

b. What does the idiom ‘couldn’t believe their eyes’ mean?

**The idiom ‘couldn’t believe their eyes’ means they were very surprised by what they saw.**

### **ANALYSE**

c. How did you grow an interest in reading?

**I grew interested in reading when I found stories that were exciting and easy to understand. Interesting characters and adventures made me want to read more.**

### **Read, Reflect, and Write**

1. Why do you think Meena hated books?

**Meena hated books because they were everywhere in her house and her parents forced her to read, which made her feel annoyed.**

2. Why did Meena begin reading? What happened that led to this?

**Meena began reading when the characters came out of the books and created chaos. She realized that reading was the only way to send them back into their stories.**

3. What advice would you give to a friend who says they do not enjoy reading?

**I would advise my friend to start with short and interesting books and choose topics they like. Reading becomes enjoyable when we find the right book.**

### **MCQs**

**1. Why did Meena hate books?**

- a. They were too expensive
- b. They were always in the way**
- c. She could not read
- d. They were too heavy

**2. Why did Max prefer to stay on top of books rather than below them?**

- a. He liked to sleep on books
- b. A big atlas had fallen on his tail once**
- c He was afraid of heights
- d. He wanted to read books

**3. Where was Max found one morning?**

- a. In the bathtub
- b. Under the stairs

**c. On top of the tallest stack of books**

- d. Inside a cupboard

**4. What happened when the books fell down?**

- a. The books got torn
- b. The room became silent
- c. Meena ran away

**d. People and animals came out of the books**

**5. What finally made Meena start reading the books?**

**a. She needed to put the characters back into their books**

- b. She wanted to impress her parents
- c. Her parents forced her
- d. She felt bored